



The AI agent that automates the *entirety* of immigration.

One shared workspace where employers, immigrants, and counsel run every case — intake to compliance — while AI does the operational work and lawyers approve the law.

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Built by someone the system was built to keep out.

Sammy Abdella

Founder & CEO — Columbia University, B.S. Computer Science

At 18, Sammy fled Tunisia — where being gay is criminalized — taught himself English on public-library computers, and earned admission to Columbia. He lived the immigration system as a lifeline, and is building Ellis on his own O-1 petition today.

An AI researcher and engineer, he turned down an offer at Google to build Ellis — named after the island that once welcomed America's immigrants.

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|--|---|
| Amazon — Software Development Engineer Intern | Casca (fintech) — Backend Engineer Intern |
| Columbia AI Lab — Researcher & published co-author | Columbia IT — migrated 43 sites; admissions platform at 50k+ applicants / cycle |
| Built Ellis end-to-end, solo: 3 products, 12 AI capabilities | Languages: English, French, Arabic |

Immigration isn't one filing. It's a recurring operating system — and it runs on inboxes.

Every case spans employer, employee, and counsel across onboarding, filing, renewals, travel, compliance, and RFEs. The legal decision is small; the operational work around it is enormous — and it's done by hand.

What it costs today

- Routine operational work is billed at attorney rates.
- Documents scatter across email, Slack, HRIS, and government portals.
- Missed deadlines, expirations, and RFEs quietly become denials.

Why it persists

- No shared source of truth across the three stakeholders.
- Legacy tools digitize forms — they don't do the work.
- Lawyers are trapped chasing documents instead of practicing law.

One workspace. Every case. The AI does the work; counsel approves the law.

Ellis turns scattered inputs into a managed immigration case — shared by employee, employer, and counsel.

1 • Connect the case

Employee and employer documents, plus context from Slack, email, HRIS, portals, and notices.

2 • Build the case

AI extracts facts, checks evidence, flags gaps, and tracks every deadline.

3 • Coordinate everyone

Shared tasks, status, approvals, reminders, and case-grounded Q&A.

4 • Run the lifecycle

Filings, daily compliance audits, renewals, and travel — automated.

Around the decision

Document review, risk flags, notice summaries, form prep, evidence packets, translation.

On-device AI

Runs locally — private by default, with zero marginal token cost.

A full product — built, working, and demo-ready.

Built end-to-end by a solo technical founder: three role-based products on one shared workspace, with realistic US & Canada case templates ready for live demos.

3

Role-based products: employer, immigrant, counsel

US + CA

Work, study & travel — any country of origin

12

AI capabilities live — extraction to compliance

\$0

Marginal AI cost — on-device engine, no API fees

Next: convert design-partner conversations with tech-forward employers and immigration boutiques into paid pilots.

Large, recurring, and underserved.

Recurring by nature — every visa renews, every employee re-files, every year.

LAYER	DEFINITION	SIZE
TAM	Global immigration legal & services spend	\$30B+
SAM	US + Canada employment, study & travel operations	\$9B
SOM	Tech-forward employers + immigration boutiques (3-yr)	\$500M

Market sizing reflects internal estimates from public immigration-services and legal-spend data.

Raising *\$260K* to turn lived hardship into lasting infrastructure.

A pre-seed round to fund the founder's O-1 petition, a 12-month runway, and the push from a working product to paid pilots.

\$260K

Pre-seed round — product, go-to-market, and founder runway

12 mo

Runway to first revenue and design-partner pilots

O-1

Founder immigration status secured in parallel